

Jothi Tutor Development Standards

TUTOR RESIDENCY PROGRESS FRAMEWORK

The operational pathway from first observation to certified independent teaching

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1. Purpose of This Document

This document defines the residency pathway for tutors entering the Johti Tutor Academy. It sets out how tutors progress from early observation through to independent teaching — and what is expected at each stage.

The residency is not a course to be completed. It is a structured development process with increasing teaching responsibility, mentor-guided feedback, and evidence-based progression. Tutors advance when they are ready, not when time runs out.

This document supersedes JTD03 v1.0. It replaces the theoretical stage description with a clear operational account of how the residency works in practice, including the PDCA development rhythm, lesson scope at each stage, and the role of the mentor panel in progression decisions.

Related Documents

- JTD01 v2.0 — Tutor Competency Framework
- JTD02 v2.0 — Tutor Lesson Reflection Standard
- JTD04 v2.0 — Mentor Observation Standard
- JTD05 — Tutor Evidence Dashboard
- JTD06 v2.0 — Tutor Certification and Sign-Off Standard
- JTS01 v2.0 — Lesson Delivery Standard
- JF01 v2.0 — Johti Tutor Academy Executive Foundation

2. The Residency at a Glance

Stage	Indicative Weeks	Lesson Scope	Competency Focus	Progression Gate
Observation	Weeks 1–2	None — tutor watches	Awareness of JCT1 behaviours	Mentor confirmation + induction reflection
Co-Teaching	Weeks 3–6	15–20 minute sections	JCT1 emerging	Mentor panel review of guided practice evidence
Lead Teaching	Weeks 7–12	30 → 45 → 60 minute lessons	JCT1 consistent; JCT2 developing	Mentor panel review of assisted delivery evidence
Independent Teaching	Weeks 13–18+	Full 6-week teaching cycle	JCT2 consolidating; JCT3 emerging	Mentor panel review → Certification Runway
Certification Runway	Weeks 18+	Final evidence gaps closed	All levels evidenced to threshold	Mentor panel certification decision (see JTD06)

Weeks are indicative, not fixed. Some tutors will move faster; some will need more time in a particular stage. The framework accommodates variation. Standards do not vary.

3. Core Principles

Principle	What It Means in Practice
Readiness, not time served	Tutors progress when evidence of readiness is sufficient — not automatically when weeks pass.
Graduated responsibility	Teaching scope increases in defined steps. Tutors do not jump from watching a lesson to teaching an hour of it.
Evidence-based decisions	Every progression and certification decision is backed by observation records, reflection records, and mentor panel review.
PDCA development rhythm	Every stage follows the same internal cycle: plan, teach, reflect, and improve. The scope of teaching changes; the rhythm does not.
Active mentor involvement	Mentors are not supervisors who tick boxes. They observe, coach, give focused feedback, and make judgements about readiness.
Competency and stage are distinct	Being in Lead Teaching does not mean JCT1 is complete. Both must be assessed independently. Do not conflate stage progress with competency sign-off.

4. The Development Rhythm — Plan, Teach, Reflect, Improve

Every stage of the residency follows the same internal cycle. What changes is the scope of teaching responsibility. What does not change is the expectation that each lesson goes through this loop.

Step	Action	What This Looks Like at Each Stage
Plan	Prepare the lesson section or full lesson with a clear focus.	Observation: tutor identifies what to watch for using the 4T lens. Co-Teaching: tutor prepares a 15–20 minute section in discussion with mentor. Lead Teaching: tutor plans the lesson structure, expected difficulties, and checking strategy. Independent Teaching: tutor plans the full 6-week cycle including assessment point.
Teach	Deliver the planned section or lesson.	Observation: no teaching. Active, structured watching of the mentor's lesson. Co-Teaching: deliver the agreed section with mentor present. Lead Teaching: lead 30, 45, or 60 minutes with mentor observing. Independent Teaching: lead full lessons across the 6-week cycle.
Reflect	Complete the JTD02 reflection form immediately after the lesson.	All stages: tutor rates the 4T elements, identifies the competency focus, records evidence, and names one next-step target. Mentor completes JTD04 observation form where observation took place.
Improve	Act on the identified target in the next lesson.	The improvement target from the previous reflection becomes the focus of the next plan. Mentors check whether the target was acted on. This loop is the mechanism of development.

The loop does not close with reflection. It closes when the improvement target has been acted on and its effect has been observed. Tutors who reflect well but do not change teaching are not using the loop correctly.

5. Stage 1 — Observation

Stage 1 — Observation <i>Indicative: Weeks 1–2</i>		
Competency Focus	- No competency sign-off in this stage. - Tutor builds awareness of JCT1 behaviours by seeing them in live lessons. - JCT1 competencies C1, C2, C3, F2, F3, F4 should be identifiable by the end of this stage.	
Lesson Scope	- Tutor teaches nothing in this stage. - Full lesson observed. Tutor uses the 4T Teaching Engine as the observation lens. - Tutor notes specific teaching moves, not just topic content.	
PDCA Rhythm	- Plan: identify what to watch for — which 4T element and which JCT1 competency. - Teach: watch and take structured notes. - Reflect: complete JTD02 form as an Observation entry.	

	Mentor Role	- Improve: bring questions and specific observations to the next mentor discussion. - Mentor teaches the observed lesson normally. - After the lesson, mentor leads a debrief — asking what the tutor noticed and filling in gaps. - Mentor confirms whether the tutor's observation is active (noticing teaching moves) or passive (noting only topic coverage).
	Readiness Signals	- Tutor can describe specific teaching moves they observed — not just what was taught. - Tutor connects observations to the 4T model. - Tutor's reflection shows genuine engagement, not a summary of the lesson content. - Tutor has questions ready for the debrief.
	Progression Gate	- Mentor confirmation that observation is active and purposeful. - Induction reflection form completed honestly. - Mentor panel reviews before tutor moves to Co-Teaching.

What Active Observation Looks Like

There is a clear difference between watching a lesson and reading a lesson. Tutors in Observation stage are expected to read the lesson.

Passive Watching (Weak)	Active Observation (Expected)
Notes what topic was taught	Notes how the concept was explained and why that approach was used
Writes 'asked lots of questions'	Notes specific questions asked and what they revealed about student thinking
Observes that the student 'got it'	Identifies the exact moment understanding shifted and what caused it
Has nothing to ask in the debrief	Arrives at the debrief with specific questions about teaching decisions

6. Stage 2 — Co-Teaching

Stage 2 — Co-Teaching <i>Indicative: Weeks 3–6</i>		
	Competency Focus	- JCT1 competencies begin to emerge in live teaching. - F2 (reliability) and F3 (mentor engagement) must be visible from the first co-teaching session. - C1 (explanation), C2 (questioning), C3 (checking) are the primary development focus.
	Lesson Scope	- Tutor leads one planned section of 15–20 minutes within the mentor's lesson. - Mentor is present throughout and takes over if needed.

	PDCA Rhythm	- Scope expands within this stage — later sessions may run two short sections rather than one. - Plan: tutor and mentor agree the section in advance — topic, likely difficulty, checking strategy. - Teach: tutor leads the section. Mentor observes without interrupting unless necessary. - Reflect: both tutor and mentor complete their respective forms. - Improve: next session begins with the previous improvement target as the explicit focus.
	Mentor Role	- Agrees the section scope and prepares the tutor in advance. - Observes live and completes JTD04 form. - Conducts a brief post-session debrief — one strength, one improvement target, nothing more. - Does not take over unless the student's learning is at serious risk.
	Readiness Signals Progression Gate	- Tutor completes the planned section without losing structure. - Explanation is followable even if not yet fluent. - Tutor attempts to check understanding rather than moving straight on. - Tutor remains composed and can hear feedback without defensiveness. - Minimum 2 mentor observations completed with JTD04 records. - JCT1 behaviours beginning to appear consistently. - Mentor panel reviews all evidence before confirming move to Lead Teaching.

Co-Teaching Is Not Being Handed the Easy Parts

The section the tutor leads in co-teaching should be a real teaching section — a new concept, a checking sequence, or a misconception correction — not a recap or an admin task. The mentor and tutor should agree in advance that the chosen section will produce meaningful evidence.

The mentor should avoid rescuing the tutor too quickly. Letting the tutor work through a difficult moment (while the mentor watches carefully) produces more development than stepping in at the first sign of difficulty.

7. Stage 3 — Lead Teaching

Stage 3 — Lead Teaching <i>Indicative: Weeks 7–12</i>		
	Competency Focus	- All JCT1 competencies should be consistent and signable by the end of this stage. - JCT2 competencies (A1, A2, B1, B2, C4, C5, D1, E1, E2) are the primary development focus. - F1 (parent communication) may begin here under mentor oversight.
	Lesson Scope	Four structured lead teaching sessions with increasing scope:

	PDCA Rhythm	• Session 1: 30 minutes Session 2: 45 minutes Session 3: 60 minutes Session 4: 60 minutes + checkpoint • Tutor leads the full duration. Mentor observes and debrief follows each session. • Plan: tutor prepares the full lesson — concept, sequence, misconceptions, checking strategy. • Teach: tutor leads. Mentor observes using JTD04 lens. • Reflect: both forms completed. Tutor identifies competency focus and evidence. • Improve: improvement target from debrief is explicitly carried into the next session plan.
	Mentor Role	• Completes JTD04 observation record for every lead teaching session. • Identifies which JCT1 competencies are now consistent and which need more evidence. • Identifies which JCT2 competencies are emerging. • At Session 4 checkpoint: convenes or contributes to mentor panel review of readiness for Independent Teaching.
	Readiness Signals	• Tutor can hold a full 60-minute lesson without losing structure, pace, or student engagement. • JCT1 competency evidence is consistent across multiple lessons. • Tutor can identify their own teaching errors after the lesson without prompting. • Tutor acts on improvement targets between sessions rather than starting each session fresh.
	Progression Gate	• Session 4 checkpoint completed with full JTD04 records for all four sessions. • Minimum 3 mentor observations on record. • JCT1 sign-off confirmed or remaining JCT1 gaps identified and addressed. • Mentor panel reviews full Lead Teaching evidence before confirming move to Independent Teaching.

The Lesson Duration Progression Is Deliberate

The $30 \rightarrow 45 \rightarrow 60 \rightarrow 60$ sequence is not arbitrary. Each step introduces a new challenge:

- 30 minutes: Can the tutor sustain a coherent section?
- 45 minutes: Can they manage transitions and maintain pace across a longer span?
- 60 minutes: Can they hold the whole lesson together — beginning, middle, and end — with quality sustained throughout?
- 60 minutes (second): Is the first 60-minute lesson a one-off or is the quality becoming repeatable?

The second 60-minute session matters as much as the first. Consistency is the standard, not peak performance.

8. Stage 4 — Independent Teaching

Stage 4 — Independent Teaching <i>Indicative: Weeks 13–18</i>		
	Competency Focus	- JCT2 competencies consolidate and are signed off during this stage. - JCT3 competencies (A3, B3, D2, D3, D4) begin to appear. - All domains should show evidence by the end of the 6-week cycle.
	Lesson Scope	- Tutor runs a full 6-week teaching cycle on one topic or unit: - Teaching 6 full lessons across 6 weeks - Preparing students for the end-of-cycle assessment - Running or supporting the assessment - Marking and reviewing outcomes - Preparing a progress update for parents under mentor oversight
	PDCA Rhythm	- Plan: tutor and mentor agree the 6-week cycle in advance — topic, lesson sequence, assessment point, competency priorities. - Teach: tutor leads all 6 lessons. Mentor oversight continues but presence is not required every session. - Reflect: JTD02 form completed after each lesson. - Improve: patterns across the cycle are reviewed at the Stage Review — not just individual lesson improvements.
	Mentor Role	- Agrees the cycle plan before it begins. - Observes a minimum of 2 lessons during the cycle and completes JTD04 records. - Reviews all 6 tutor reflections. - Arranges at least 1 second-mentor calibration observation during the cycle. - Leads the Stage Review at cycle completion. - Confirms whether evidence is sufficient for Certification Runway or whether a further cycle is needed.
	Readiness Signals	- Tutor can sustain quality across six lessons, not just in isolated sessions. - Assessment is used to inform teaching decisions — not just to record a mark. - Tutor can prepare a clear and evidence-based parent progress update. - JCT2 competencies are showing consistent evidence. - JCT3 competencies are beginning to appear in the cycle evidence.
	Progression Gate	- All 6 lessons delivered. - All 6 JTD02 reflections submitted. - Minimum 2 JTD04 mentor observation records. 1 second-mentor calibration observation on record. - Stage Review completed with mentor. - Mentor panel decision: Certification Runway or extended cycle.

The 6-Week Cycle Is the Central Evidence Block

The Independent Teaching cycle is where the strongest certification evidence is built. It is the only stage in which the tutor's teaching can be judged across time — not just in a single lesson. The mentor panel will look closely at pattern across the cycle, not at individual peaks.

A tutor who teaches brilliantly in Lesson 1 and poorly in Lesson 4 is not ready. A tutor who teaches consistently well across six lessons, responds to assessment evidence, and can account for student progress is.

9. Certification Runway

The Certification Runway is not another residency stage. It is the final preparation phase before the certification decision. By the time a tutor enters the Certification Runway, they should already have substantial evidence from Observation through to Independent Teaching.

The Runway has one purpose: close any remaining evidence gaps identified by the mentor panel, then submit the full evidence pack for review.

Step	What Happens
Final Evidence Plan	Mentor panel reviews the full JTD05 dashboard and identifies which competencies still need stronger evidence. A specific and time-bound plan is agreed. No vague 'continue developing' — specific lessons or tasks are named.
Final Evidence Sessions	Tutor completes the agreed final actions. These may include a targeted lesson focused on one competency, a parent communication demonstration, or a second-mentor calibration observation.
Final Readiness Pack	All evidence is collated — JTD02 reflections, JTD04 observation records, calibration observations, assessment evidence, and parent communication evidence where relevant.
Certification Decision	Mentor panel reviews the full pack. Decision: Certified / Certified with targets / Extended Runway / Not yet certified. See JTD06 for the full certification decision process.

For the full certification and sign-off process, see JTD06 v2.0 — Tutor Certification and Sign-Off Standard.

10. The Mentor Panel

Progression between stages and the final certification decision are not made by a single mentor. They are made by the mentor panel — a collective review of the available evidence by the mentors involved in a tutor's development.

This is not bureaucracy. A single mentor's impression — however well-intentioned — can be influenced by personal rapport, recent performance, or incomplete visibility. The panel provides a check on that.

What the Mentor Panel Reviews at Each Gate

Gate	Evidence Reviewed
Observation → Co-Teaching	Induction reflection form. Mentor confirmation that observation has been active and purposeful.
Co-Teaching → Lead Teaching	Minimum 2 JTD04 mentor observation records. JTD02 reflection records. Assessment of whether JCT1 behaviours are beginning to appear consistently.
Lead Teaching → Independent Teaching	JTD04 records for all 4 lead teaching sessions. JCT1 sign-off status. JCT2 emergence evidence. Mentor panel discussion of readiness.
Independent Teaching → Certification Runway	All 6-lesson cycle evidence. JTD02 reflections. JTD04 observations. Second-mentor calibration. JTD05 dashboard status. Stage Review discussion notes.
Certification Decision	Full Final Readiness Pack. Competency coverage against JTD01 v2.0 thresholds. Pattern of evidence quality. Mentor panel confidence in sustained independent teaching capability.

11. Common Progression Risks — What to Avoid

Risk	Why It Damages the Residency
Moving a tutor forward because the weeks have passed	Time is not evidence. A tutor who has spent six weeks in Co-Teaching without demonstrating JCT1 behaviours is not ready for Lead Teaching, regardless of the calendar.
Conflating confidence with competence	A confident tutor who does not diagnose misconceptions or check understanding is not performing at standard. Confidence without skill is a risk, not an asset.
Letting the reflection loop collapse	If tutors complete forms but do not act on improvement targets, the loop is broken. The improvement target from reflection must appear in the next lesson plan.
One mentor making all progression decisions	The mentor panel exists to prevent single-mentor bias. Bypass it and the quality of progression decisions weakens.
Accepting self-report as evidence	A tutor's confidence rating on their reflection form is a developmental signal, not evidence of competency. Observed evidence from the mentor is required.
Certifying to fill a staffing need	Operational pressure is the most common cause of premature certification. It produces tutors who are not ready and students who receive substandard teaching. Do not do it.

12. Evidence Expectations by Stage

Evidence Type	Observation	Co-Teaching	Lead Teaching	Independent Teaching
JTD02 Tutor Reflection	1 (post-observation)	1 per session	1 per session (4 minimum)	1 per lesson (6 minimum)
JTD04 Mentor Observation	None required	Minimum 2	All 4 sessions	Minimum 2, with 1 calibration
Competency sign-off	None	F2, F3, F4 can begin	JCT1 target complete	JCT2 consolidating; JCT3 beginning
Mentor panel review	Before Co-Teaching	Before Lead Teaching	Before Independent Teaching	Before Certification Runway

13. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
PDCA rhythm made explicit with stage-by-stage description	v1.0 described PDCA as a general principle without showing how it operates at each stage. v2.0 specifies what plan/teach/reflect/improve looks like in Observation, Co-Teaching, Lead Teaching, and Independent Teaching.
Lesson duration progression stated explicitly	v1.0 did not specify lesson durations. v2.0 defines the 15–20 → 30 → 45 → 60 → 60 → 6-week cycle sequence.
Mentor panel progression gates formalised	v1.0 described mentor observation without specifying who makes progression decisions. v2.0 makes clear that the mentor panel reviews evidence at every stage gate.
Stage terminology aligned to JF01 v2.0	Observation / Co-Teaching / Lead Teaching / Independent Teaching are the canonical JTA stage names, consistent across all documents and SKOOL modules.
Certification Runway described as a distinct final phase	v1.0 merged residency and certification. v2.0 clearly separates the developmental pathway (JTD03) from the formal certification decision process (JTD06).
Repetitive narrative sections removed throughout	v1.0 restated the importance of evidence, mentor involvement, and readiness-based progression multiple times across separate sections. v2.0 states each principle once, clearly.

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